



Google Play Music update

The service now provides faster music downloads with few search improvements and data usage tweaks.



Temple Run support extended

Temple Run for Windows Phone 8 is updated to support phones with 512MB of RAM. Now don't miss it any more..

Sculptris Alpha 6

We show you how to take your first baby steps into the world of 3D modelling with this easy to use application.

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Pixologic Sculptris Alpha 6 is a great program for introducing newbies to 3D Modelling. With Sculptris, you can create 3D models in a few easy steps without having any prior knowledge of modelling. The best part is that Sculptris is available for free on the Pixologic website. Head over to <http://pixologic.com/sculptris/>, fill a form and download the software for either Windows or Mac OS X. In this workshop, we'll give you the basic know-how on getting started with your first project. But first, let's look at some of the requirements.

Prerequisites

Sculptris requires Pentium 4 or above to run on Windows XP, Vista or higher and 2GHz Core 2 Duo or above to run on Mac OS X 10.5 or 10.6. Both systems need at least 1GB RAM and AMD or Nvidia graphics card with OpenGL 2.0 support. Since 3D sculpting is hardware rendered, a powerful graphics card is essential for better performance.

The interface

Once you're running Sculptris, you'll see a very simple interface with only the essential tools displayed. Once you're familiar with these tools and shortcuts, you'll be good to go. Let's take a look at the interface in detail.

1. **Working area:** This is the work space where you'll be making the model.
2. **Status Bar:** Located at the bottom, the status bar shows view angle and the number of triangles the model has.

3. **Menu Panel:** On the left-hand side of the working area is a collection of buttons which are tools you'll be working with to create your model.

The first three rows consist of nine 'sculpt brushes'. You'll be using these brushes to sculpt and manipulate your model. They include:

- Draw – Extrudes or pulls the clay outwards.
- Crease – This is the opposite of the Draw brush. It digs into the clay.
- Flatten – Makes rounded areas flat. It can also reduce areas or make them more regular.
- and others...

The next two rows in the Menu Panel are Utility tools; they're used to add more details to your model. Included in this set of tools are:

- Reduce Brush – Decreases the polygon count.
- Reduce Selected – Reduces the number of triangles. Same as above tool.
- Subdivide all – Sub-divides the wire mesh and increases polygon count for more detailing.
- Mask – Identifies an untouchable area
- New Sphere – Creates a new clay object in a spherical form.
- New Plane – Creates a new clay object in a plane form.
- and others...

4. **Action Bar:** This set of options is to the adjacent right of the Menu Panel. It consists of a set of tweaking tools that let you refine any of the other brushes, such as size, strength, and clay type etc. For quick and effective camera views, use mouse scroll to zoom in and out. [Alt] + right-click will pan; right-clicking, holding and moving the mouse will change the camera angle and [Z] will reset camera view to nearest default position.

Modelling a simple face

Now that you're introduced to every element, let's start making a simple model



Using Grab tool to pull the nose out



Using Draw tool to make the ears



The completed face will look like this

of a human face. With Sculptris, you'll always begin by creating a geometric shape, which will either be a sphere or a plane. To create the model of a face, we'll begin by bringing up a sphere-shaped clay model, so click on the New Sphere button. Make sure 'Symmetry' tool is on as you'll need it all the time. Then, follow these steps:

1. Select Grab tool [G], set the brush size and slightly flatten the clay from the sides to give it the shape of a head.
2. Next, use Draw tool [D]. Set the brush size and draw an eyebrow. Since we've turned on the Symmetry tool, the eyebrow drawn on one side of the face will reflect on the other side.